so.

"My husband," said Gertrude, "scored 160."

"116?"

"No, 160. One-six-oh."

"How do you know?"

"He told me so."

The other girl snickered. "And you believe him?"

When Gertrude eventually told me this, with great indignation, I said curiously, "But how do you know you can believe me? How do you know I'm not lying?"

And she said, "But 160 is average for you. Why should you lie?"

I don't imagine Gertrude ever thought I was perfect, but she certainly never doubted my intelligence.

On November 6, I had further proof of just how valuable I was to the Army in view of my intelligence.

I was given my first KP assignment, and spent all day in the mess hall performing various menial tasks.

This is understandable, I suppose. Someone has to do them and it is the essence of military democracy that all menials take their fair turn.

What was a lot less comprehensible was that no provision was made for storing the outer wear of the soldiers doing KP. It was cold enough outside to be wearing a field jacket, but no place of security was provided for me to store that field jacket. It had to be left out in the open, and it was stolen. I was charged $14 for a replacement of lesser quality and was "chewed out" for the high crime of allowing it to be stolen. "Chewed out" is an Army term that means being barked at incoherently by a sergeant who, in all likelihood, was the animal who stole the field jacket.

Camp Lee

On Thursday, November 8, after having been in the Army a week, I was